

ZEINAH ABDELSALAM

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EDUCATION

GEORGETOWN UNIVERSITY, Walsh School of Foreign Service

Washington, D.C.

M.S. in Foreign Service, Science & Technology in International Affairs, STEM-designated (GPA: 3.9)

Expected May 2027

Concentration: Energy & the Global Environment | Certificates: African Studies, Diplomatic Studies

- **Coursework:** Energy Diplomacy, The Electric Grid, Science Policy Matters, Cyber Policy & Strategy; incoming Energy Transition, Deep Decarbonization, China's Evolving Role in Africa, International Climate Policy & Diplomacy
 - Authored a policy memo for Secretary Chris Wright on the IMO Net-Zero Framework and U.S. strategic positioning; completed OPEC, IEA, G7, and FERC simulations
 - Activities: SFS Energy Club, NCAC-USAE, NCS-SPE, Africa Forum, Georgetown AI Association

WEST VIRGINIA WESLEYAN COLLEGE

Buckhannon, W.V.

B.S. in Economics & Political Science, *Summa Cum Laude* (GPA: 4.0)

May 2025

EXPERIENCE

AQUIA GROUP

Washington, D.C.

Energy, Tech, & Trade Policy Associate

Sep 2025-Present

- Monitor domestic and international energy, environmental, and economic policy for clients, producing a weekly digest that translates a fast-moving landscape into analysis decision-makers can act on, and managing its firm-wide distribution.
- Produce and circulate rapid-turnaround summaries of key hearings and events, and draft meeting briefings, bio books, and prep materials supporting client engagements.
- Engage directly with high-profile energy and tech clients and Hill staff in lobbying meetings.
- Run live client events and high-level panels end to end, from logistics and operations to escorting principals and ensuring readiness on the ground, including the firm's inaugural Agentic Futures Initiative (AFI) annual symposium.

GEORGETOWN SCHOOL OF FOREIGN SERVICE

Washington, D.C.

MSFS Communications & Events Assistant

Aug 2025-Present

- Create and manage digital content for MSFS social media, website, newsletter, and alumni fundraising campaigns, including writing impact stories, designing graphics, and maintaining webpages.
- Plan and execute program-level events open to the wider School of Foreign Service, handling room setup and layout, A/V readiness, catering coordination, and event promotion.

ORION STRATEGIES

Washington, D.C., & Buckhannon, W.V. Intern

May 2024-Aug 2025

- Produced 15+ concise reports synthesizing high-level conferences, federal agency events, and congressional hearings on energy, environmental, and AI/tech policy.
- Maintained legislator and committee profiles for the 119th Congress through direct coordination with congressional offices, and represented the office at public forums and Orion-sponsored Hill events.
- Authored 100+ page "Lay of the Land" memos for energy and health clients, mapping stakeholder networks, regulatory agencies, market landscapes, and public temperatures.
- Co-authored op-eds, reviewed a weekly newsletter, and developed social media advertising strategy; maintained stakeholder engagement databases in Excel.

SELECT PUBLICATIONS

- "The Mediterranean's Energy Moment: A Case for Regional Action" – *Trends Research & Advisory*, June 2026; includes original correspondence with Geoffrey Pyatt, former U.S. Ambassador, Assistant Secretary of State for Energy Resources
- "The Adversary's Forecast: How Extreme Weather and AI-Enabled Cyber Capabilities Are Creating the Perfect Storm to Attack the Power Grid" – *Science & Politics*, June 2026

SELECT PROJECTS

- "The Age of Climate Pragmatism" – policy paper arguing the world faces energy addition, not transition; analyzed COP30 outcomes, U.S.-China rivalry, and energy trilemma dynamics.
- "Critical Minerals as the Organizing Logic of Contemporary Globalization" – research paper on China's midstream dominance, Africa/Latin America structural asymmetry, and U.S. industrial policy response.
- Tabletop exercises simulating adversarial threats to U.S. critical infrastructure, including the electric grid subsector.

LANGUAGES & ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Languages: English (Native – C2), Arabic (Native – C2), French (Beginner – A1)

Computer Skills: SPSS, Stata, MS Office Suite (data analysis, visualization), Google Apps, Canva, iMovie, Wix, Mailchimp